LABOR RELATIONS

UNITED STATES
POSTAL SERVICE

June 14, 1996

Mr. Robert C. Pritchard
. Director, Motor Vehicle Services Division
American Postal Workers Union,
AFL-CIO
1300 L Street, N.W.
Washington, DC 20005-4107

Dear Mr. Pritchard:

This responds to your most recent letter concerning Department of Transportation (DOT) physicals for employees with Commercial Drivers Licenses (CDLs).

As I previously stated, the Postal Service does not prohibit an employee from obtaining a DOT physical on their own time and at their own expense. Whether we "contest the validity of a DOT physical card" is immaterial. If employees choose to obtain their own physical for a state license, it is their option. However, Postal Service policy states that the DOT physical will be scheduled by postal management, occur on the clock at a Medical Unit or Contract Medical Facility, and be paid for by the Postal Service. Employees with CDLs must comply with this policy to ensure that they are medically fit to drive for the Postal Service. The Postal Service does not require employees to "pass a second or third physical" as you have suggested. Employees are required to pass the physical scheduled by the Postal Service. Our policy permits us to determine whether employees meet our requirements for driving for the Postal Service.

As you-may not be aware, this established policy was discussed during several meetings with your predecessor, Donald Ross. Following these discussions, and at the request of the union, the Postal Service issued a policy, which parallels the DOT's requirements as they pertain to medical physicals for employees with a CDL. The union offered no objections, and in fact concurred with the Postal Service's decision to provide the DOT physical, on the clock, at no cost to the employee. The policy was issued by memorandum dated February 26, 1995, and reissued on May 31, 1996 (copies enclosed). If you prefer that the employees pay for their own physicals and obtain them off the clock, please advise me, and we will take your recommendation into consideration.

I hope that this addresses your concerns regarding our policy on DOT physicals.

Sincerely,

for Anthony J. Vegliante
Manager
Contract Administration APWU/NPMHU

Enclosures

475 L'ENFANT PLAZA SW
WASHINGTON DC 20260-4100

LOGISTICS

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

June 19.1998

AREA MANAGERS, HUMAN RESOURCES
MANAGERS, DISTRIBUTION NETWORKS
MANAGERS, TRANSPORTATION AND NETWORKS
MANAGERS, VEHICLE MAINTENANCE FACILITIES
MANAGERS, PLANT MAINTENANCE

SUBJECT: Commercial Drivers License (CDL) Employee Physicals
(Supersedes all previous memoranda)

To be consistent with the trucking industry and our own contract driver requirements, U.S. Postal Service policy voluntarily parallels Department of Transportation (DOT) requirements as they **pertain to** physicals for Commercial Drivers License (CDL) employees. These requirements include **issuance** of a Medical Card.

Every CDL employee is required to have a standard DOT CDL physical every two years. The **physical** will be scheduled by postal management, occur on the clock at a Postal Service Medical Unit or Postal Service Contract Medical **Facility; and** be paid for by the Postal Service. **r s are** not authorized to have their DOT physicals conducted at medical facilities other than Postal Medical Units or Postal Contract Medical facilities.

PS Form 2485 is no bnger used for DOT physicals. The Physical Examination Form, which meets the DOT requirements and is available from **J.J.** Keller Company, is to be used by medical personnel for the physicals. When the CDL empbyee passes the DOT physical, a Medical Card will be **issued** bymedii personnel. **This** card is evidence that enables an empbyee to meet physical requirements when renewing his/her CDL with state licensing authorities. If a CDL employee fails the physical, management must immediately confer **with** Labor Relations personnel at the local level **for guidance regarding the next applicable procedure.**

If you have any questions regarding this policy, contact John Hemandez at **202-268-3553.** Thank you for your support in ensuring a safer CDL driver workforce. With your help, we can keep the Postal Service and our employees free from risk of serious consequences.

for **J. Michael Krop**
Manager
Transportation Modal Operations
and Requirements

cc: Mr. Eddy

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